

Shopify AI Development Learnings.md

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Purpose

This file exists to capture what we learn about using AI agents (Claude Code, ChatGPT, Codex, Shopify integrations, etc.) inside Daisy Maison's Shopify workflow.

The goal is not just building features.

The goal is learning the fastest, lowest-friction process for shipping improvements safely.

Learning #1: Draft Themes First

Never build directly on the live theme.

Workflow:

1. Create a fresh Shopify theme copy.
2. Give the AI agent the exact theme name.
3. Build and test there first.
4. Preview.
5. Publish only after review.

Example:

- Live theme → untouched
- Working theme → "Copy of DTD Theme"

This immediately reduces risk and stress.

Learning #2: Verify What The AI Actually Changed

AI agents frequently say:

- "Created"
- "Updated"
- "Edited"

This does not automatically mean the live store changed.

Always determine:

- Was code only created locally?
- Was it uploaded to Shopify?
- Which theme was modified?
- Was anything published?

The first debugging question should always be:

Where was the change actually made?

Learning #3: Review The Customer Experience Before The Code

The temptation is to review Liquid, JavaScript, schema, and implementation details.

For ecommerce:

The first review should be:

- Does it look good?
- Does it make sense?
- Would a customer buy it?
- Does it work on mobile?

Code quality matters.

Customer behaviour matters more.

Learning #4: Friction Kills Adoption

The best workflow is not the most technically correct workflow.

The best workflow is the one that gets used.

Avoid introducing:

- GitHub processes
- Pull requests
- Multiple review stages
- Unnecessary setup

unless the complexity genuinely requires it.

If a process creates enough friction that nobody wants to use it, it has failed.

Learning #5: Use AI As Builder + Reviewer

Most productive workflow so far:

Claude Code:

- Build
- Modify theme files
- Create implementations

ChatGPT:

- Review logic
- Challenge assumptions
- Simplify requirements
- Spot over-engineering

The value comes from using a second perspective before publishing.

Learning #6: Default To Simplicity

Example:

Initial idea:

- Multiple greeting card occasions
- Multiple variants
- Checkout note instructions
- Complex product structure

Better solution:

- One gift card product
- £3.95
- One message box
- One checkbox
- One clear customer action

Simpler usually converts better.

Learning #7: Shopify Integrations Are More Powerful Than Expected

Claude Code was able to:

- Identify themes
- Read theme files
- Inspect template structure
- Create theme files
- Prepare uploads via Shopify APIs

Future work should assume the AI may be able to interact directly with Shopify rather than only generating code locally.

Always verify actions before assuming they were completed.

Current Working Principle

When building a new Daisy Maison feature:

1. Create draft theme.
2. Give AI exact theme name.
3. Let AI build.
4. Review customer experience.
5. Test mobile.
6. Publish only when proven.

The objective is not elegant code.

The objective is profitable improvements shipped safely and quickly.